

Once edited, the images can be uploaded for hosting online. A sync feature lets you synchronise changes made to folders on your computer, to changes made to albums hosted on the internet. You can choose to either make these albums public or private, and then send the links to your friends and families. Picasaweb is not as strong a community as Flickr for enthusiasts, but Flickr is not used for sharing personal photos to the extent Picasaweb is. If you are uploading photos to share with family and friends, and these photos are of an event or an activity, it is better to use Picasa for this purpose. However, if you are taking artistic photographs, and want professional feedback for your work, then Flickr is a better web site. Picasa allows you to resize the pictures before you upload them. Use this whenever possible to save on web space. The free service provides 1 GB of free storage. According to the site, this is enough for 4000 photographs, but a lot of photographs end up being over 1 MB in size, which reduces the number to a little less than 1000. When you upload the photographs from a standard digital camera, you might run out of web space in about twenty albums, which takes about a year of regular use. If you end up regularly uploading pictures on Picasaweb, you will eventually end up doing what a lot of people do, which is to have multiple Picasaweb accounts.

12.2 Adobe Photoshop

This one is the standard across platforms, as it is available for both Mac OS and Windows machines. Unfortunately, there is no Linux port yet. The prevalence of Photoshop is so much, that 'photoshopping' or even just 'shopping' has become synonymous with image editing. Photoshop's default format for saving images is PSD. This format allows layers, masks, certain effects, paths and colour profiles to be stored in the image itself. This format stores far more information than competing formats, and the wide use of Photoshop means that many image manipulation programs support this format. A user can also store notes and audio/video commentary in the image itself, which makes it easy for an image editor and a client to compare notes and work on a project together.

There are two primary ways to manipulate an image of Photoshop, the image effects toolbar and the filters. True photo-